

ACT III



ACT 3
SCENE 1

NOW YOU HAVE IT ALL: YOU ARE KING, THANE OF CAWDOR, AND THANE OF GLAMIS, JUST AS THE WEIRD WOMEN PROMISED. AND I FEAR THAT FOUL PLAY WAS INVOLVED. BUT IT WAS ALSO PROPHESED THAT YOUR FAMILY LINE WOULD NOT KEEP THE CROWN AND THAT MY SONS AND GRANDSONS WOULD BECOME KINGS INSTEAD.

IF THE WITCHES TELL THE TRUTH—WHICH THEY HAVE FOR YOU—THEN WHY SHOULDN'T I BELIEVE THEIR WORDS?

BUT HUSH, I WILL SAY NO MORE.







DO NOT MISS
OUR FEAST.

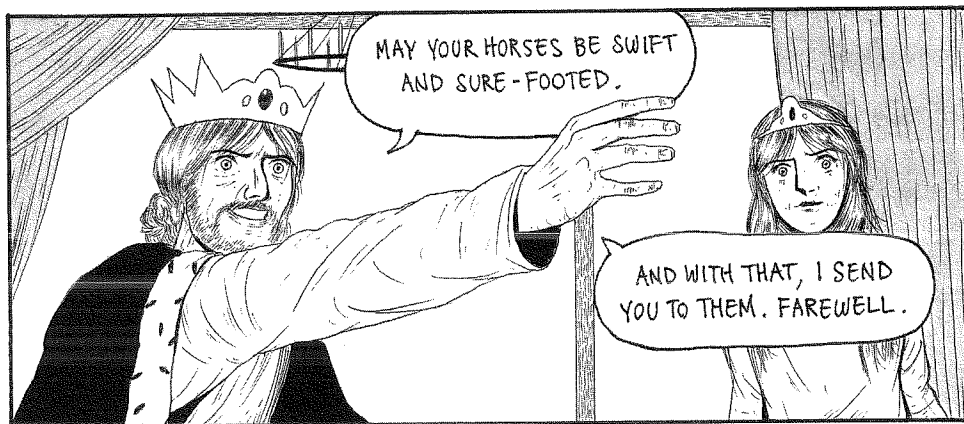
MY LORD,
I WILL NOT.



I HEAR THAT THE BLOODY PRINCES HAVE
HIDDEN THEMSELVES IN ENGLAND AND IRE-
LAND. THEY DO NOT CONFESS THEIR CRUEL
PATRICIDE, BUT INSTEAD FILL THE EARS OF
THEIR LISTENERS WITH STRANGE FICTIONS.
BUT MORE OF THAT TOMORROW, WHEN WE'LL
DISCUSS MATTERS OF STATE THAT CONCERN
US BOTH. HURRY TO YOUR HORSE.

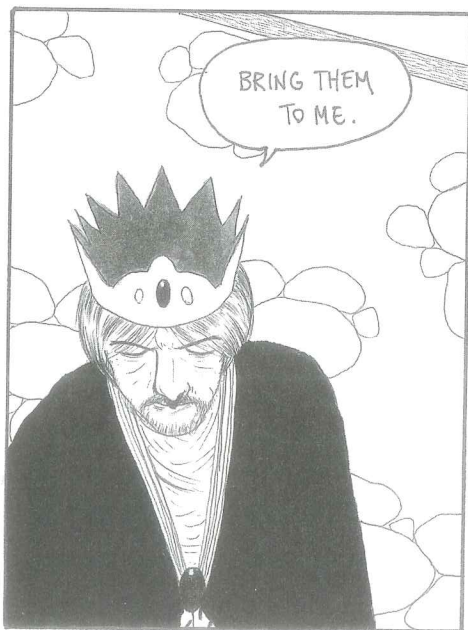
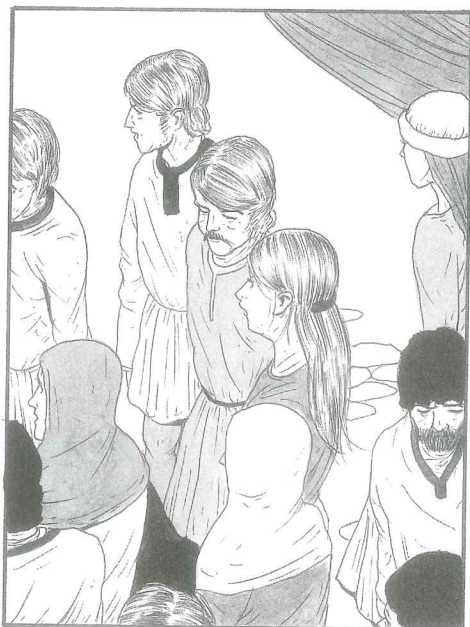
ADIEU, 'TIL YOU
RETURN AT NIGHT.
WILL FLEANCE
TRAVEL WITH YOU?

YES, MY
GOOD LORD.
OUR JOURNEY
AWAITS
US.



MAY YOUR HORSES BE SWIFT
AND SURE-FOOTED.

AND WITH THAT, I SEND
YOU TO THEM. FAREWELL.





TO BE KING IS NOTHING IF MY POSITION IS NOT SECURE. MY FEAR OF BANQUO HITS ME DEEP—HE HAS A NOBILITY OF NATURE THAT I FEAR. HE'S WILLING TO TAKE RISKS, AND, ALONG WITH A BOLD MIND, HE HAS THE WISDOM TO MATCH HIS BRAVERY WITH CAUTION.

I FEAR NONE BUT
HE MAKES MY GUARD
ANGEL TREMBLE,
OCTAVIUS CAESAR
MARK ANTONY'S

HE CHIDED THE WITCHES WHEN THEY FIRST
CALLED ME KING, BIDDING THEM TO SPEAK
TO HIM. THEN, PROPHET-LIKE, THEY TOLD
HIM HE WOULD BE FATHER TO A LINE OF
KINGS. THEY GAVE ME A CROWN AND A
SCEPTER THAT WILL WITHER WITH ME.

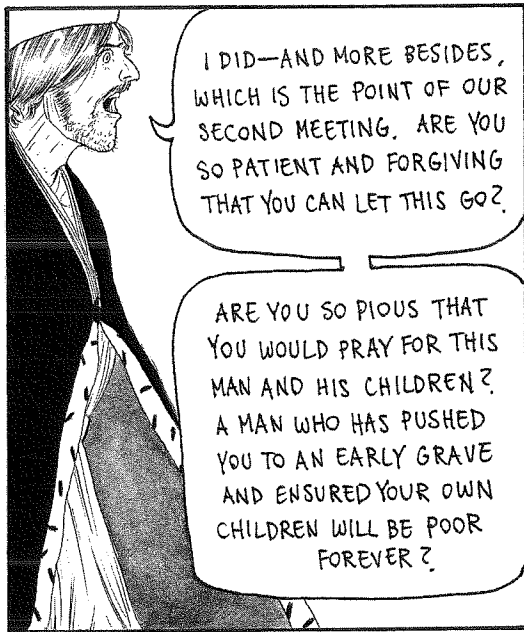
I'VE GIVEN MY SOUL, THAT EVER-
LASTING JEWEL, TO THE DEVIL SO
THAT **THEY** MIGHT BE KINGS! THE
SEEDS OF BANQUO—KINGS! FATE,
I CHALLENGE YOU! COME AND I
WILL BATTLE YOU TO THE DEATH!

POWER WILL BE WRENCHED FROM
MY HAND BY A STRANGER, NOT
SON OF MY OWN. IF THIS IS TRUE,
THEN I HAVE DEFILED MY MIND
AND MURDERED THE GRACIOUS
DUNCAN FOR BANQUO'S SONS
I'VE RUINED MY OWN PEACE FOR
THEIR BENEFIT.





YOU SHOWED
US.



I DID—AND MORE BESIDES,
WHICH IS THE POINT OF OUR
SECOND MEETING. ARE YOU
SO PATIENT AND FORGIVING
THAT YOU CAN LET THIS GO?

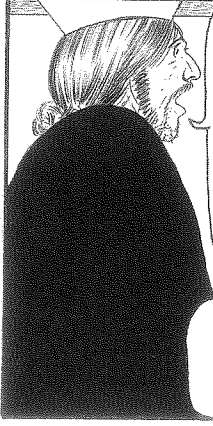
ARE YOU SO PIOUS THAT
YOU WOULD PRAY FOR THIS
MAN AND HIS CHILDREN?
A MAN WHO HAS PUSHED
YOU TO AN EARLY GRAVE
AND ENSURED YOUR OWN
CHILDREN WILL BE POOR
FOREVER?



WE ARE MEN, MY LORD.

YES, YOU BELONG TO THE
SPECIES OF MEN—JUST AS
HOUNDS AND GREYHOUNDS,
MONGRELS, SPANIELS, MUTTS,
LAPDOGS, SWIMMING DOGS,
AND DEMI-WOLVES ARE ALL
CLASSIFIED AS "DOGS." BUT
IF YOU RANK DOGS BY
THEIR QUALITIES, YOU CAN
DISTINGUISH WHICH BREEDS
ARE FAST OR SLOW, WHICH
ARE CLEVER, WHICH ARE HOUSE-
DOGS AND WHICH HUNTERS.





EACH DOG MAY BE CLASSIFIED ACCORDING TO THE NATURAL GIFTS THAT DISTINGUISH IT FROM OTHER DOGS—AND SO IT IS WITH MEN. NOW, IF YOU BELONG TO THE SPECIES OF MEN AND ARE NOT IN ITS BOTTOM RANKS, TELL ME, AND I WILL PLANT A SCHEME IN YOU THAT WILL RID YOU OF YOUR ENEMY AND BRING YOU CLOSER TO ME.

AS LONG AS THIS MAN LIVES, I AM SICK—
BUT IF HE WERE DEAD, I WOULD BE IN
THE MOST PERFECT HEALTH.



MY LORD, I HAVE
BEEN SO MISTREATED
BY THE WORLD, I'LL
DO ANYTHING TO
SPITE IT.

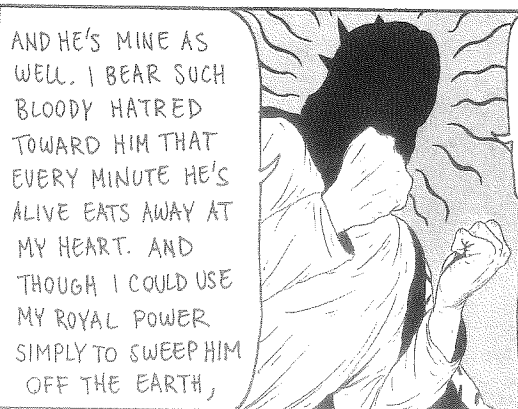


AND I AS WELL. I'M SO
WEARY OF DISASTER AND
BAD FORTUNE, I WOULD
RISK MY LIFE ON ANY
CHANCE EITHER TO MEND
IT OR BE RID OF IT.



YOU BOTH KNOW BANQUO
WAS YOUR ENEMY.

IT'S TRUE, MY LORD.



AND HE'S MINE AS
WELL. I BEAR SUCH
BLOODY HATRED
TOWARD HIM THAT
EVERY MINUTE HE'S
ALIVE EATS AWAY AT
MY HEART. AND
THOUGH I COULD USE
MY ROYAL POWER
SIMPLY TO SWEEP HIM
OFF THE EARTH,

I CANNOT, FOR WE HAVE COMMON
FRIENDS THAT I CANNOT ALIEN-
ATE. INSTEAD I MUST WAILE IN
PUBLIC FOR THE MAN I MYSELF
HAVE KILLED.

AND THIS IS WHY I SOLICIT YOUR
HELP—I MUST HIDE MY BUSINESS
FROM THE PUBLIC EYE FOR
MANY REASONS.



ACT 3
SCENE 2

HAS BANQUO
LEFT THE
COURT?

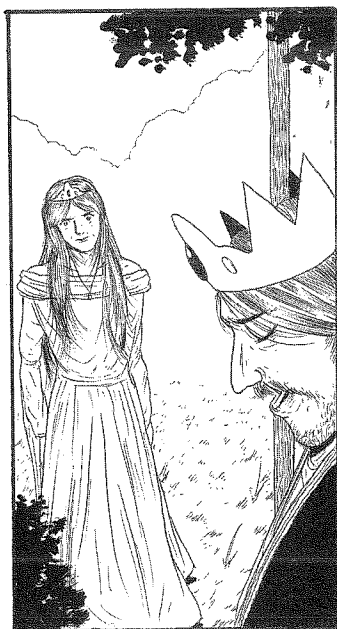
YES, MADAM,
BUT HE
RETURNS
TONIGHT.

GO TELL THE KING
THAT I WISH A
FEW WORDS WITH
HIM.

MADAM, I WILL.

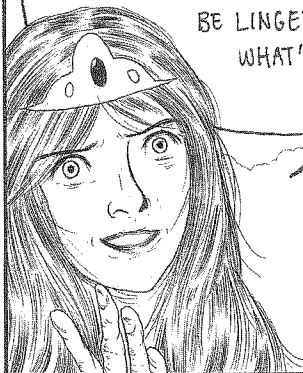
TO HAVE THE THING
YOU DESIRE BUT FEEL
NO SATISFACTION FOR
IT—WHY, THEN YOU
HAVE SPENT ALL TO
GAIN NOTHING.

SAFER TO BE THE THING
DESTROYED THAN THE
DESTROYER WHOSE JOY
IS WRACKED BY ANXIETY.



HOW IS IT WITH YOU, MY LORD? WHY DO YOU
KEEP TO YOURSELF, WITH ONLY YOUR SAD
THOUGHTS FOR COMPANY?

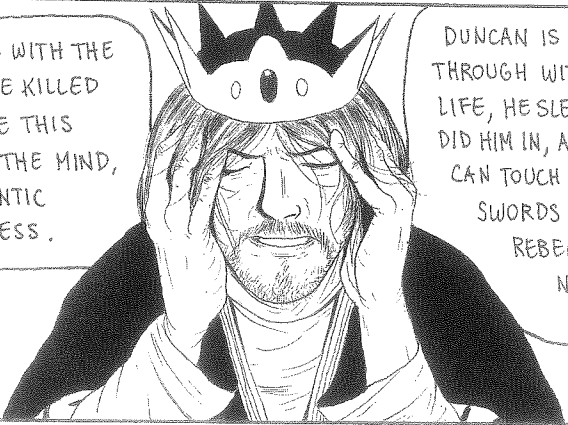
THOSE THOUGHTS SHOULD HAVE DIED WITH
THE MAN YOU THINK OF. THAT WHICH
CANNOT BE REMEDIED SHOULDN'T
BE LINGERED OVER.
WHAT'S DONE IS
DONE.



WE HAVE SLASHED THE SNAKE, NOT
KILLED IT. SHE WILL HEAL AND REVIVE,
AND WE'LL BE THREATENED BY HER
FANGS ONCE AGAIN.

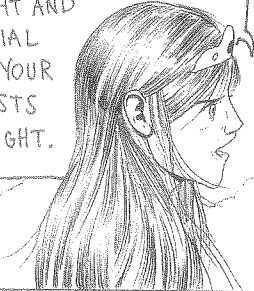
BUT THE UNIVERSE CAN
BREAK APART AND
HEAVEN AND EARTH
CAN CRUMBLE BEFORE I'LL
EAT MY MEALS IN FEAR,
OR LET THESE TERRIBLE
DREAMS THAT SHAKE
ME NIGHTLY RUIN MY
SLEEP.





BETTER TO BE WITH THE
DEAD WHOM WE KILLED
THAN ENDURE THIS
TORTURE OF THE MIND,
THIS FRANTIC
RESTLESSNESS.

DUNCAN IS IN HIS GRAVE.
THROUGH WITH THE FEVER OF
LIFE, HE SLEEPS WELL. TREASON
DID HIM IN, AND NOW NOTHING
CAN TOUCH HIM—NEITHER
SWORDS NOR POISON,
REBELLION, INVASION,
NOR ANYTHING
ELSE.

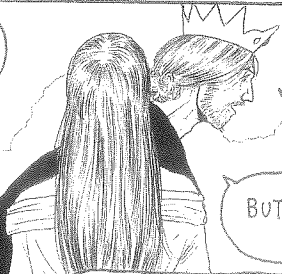


COME, MY GENTLE LORD,
COMPOSE YOURSELF. BE
BRIGHT AND
JOVIAL
WITH YOUR
GUESTS
TONIGHT.

SO I WILL, MY LOVE,
AND I PRAY THAT
YOU DO THE SAME.
GIVE BANQUO
YOUR SPECIAL
ATTENTION.



DO HIM HONOR,
BOTH WITH
YOUR LOOKS
AND YOUR WORDS.
AS LONG AS
WE'RE IN
DANGER OF
EXPOSURE, WE
MUST FLATTER
HIM AND MASK
OUR HEARTS.

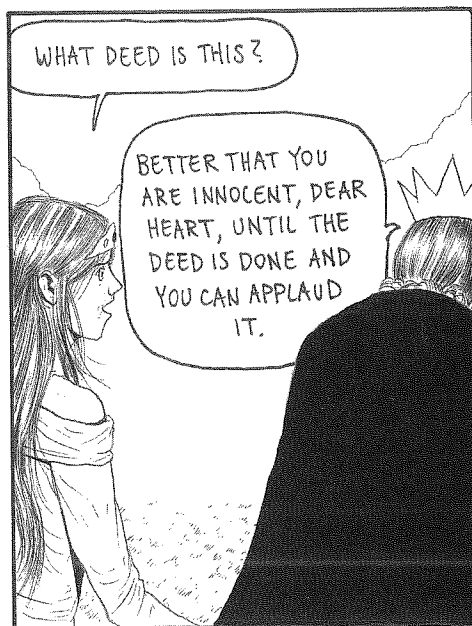


YOU MUST STOP
TALKING LIKE THIS.

OH! DEAR WIFE, MY MIND IS
FULL OF SCORPION-LIKE THOUGHTS.
YOU KNOW THAT BANQUO AND
FLEANCE STILL LIVE.

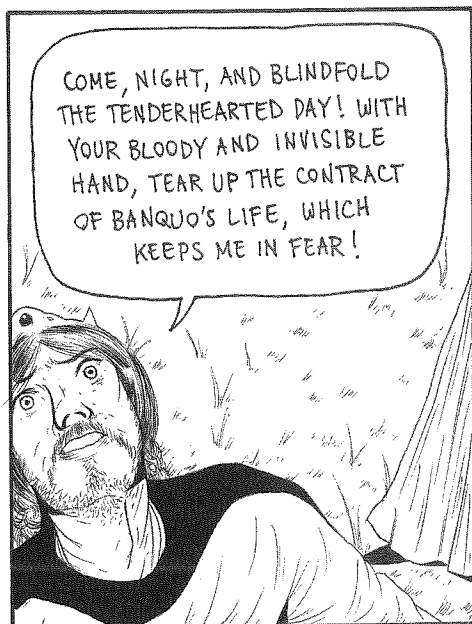
BUT THEY WON'T DO SO
FOREVER.

THERE IS COMFORT IN THAT. SO BE MERRY, BEFORE THE
BAT FLIES AND THE DUNG BEETLE RINGS IN THE NIGHT
WITH HIS DROWSY HUMS, A DREADFUL DEED WILL BE DONE.

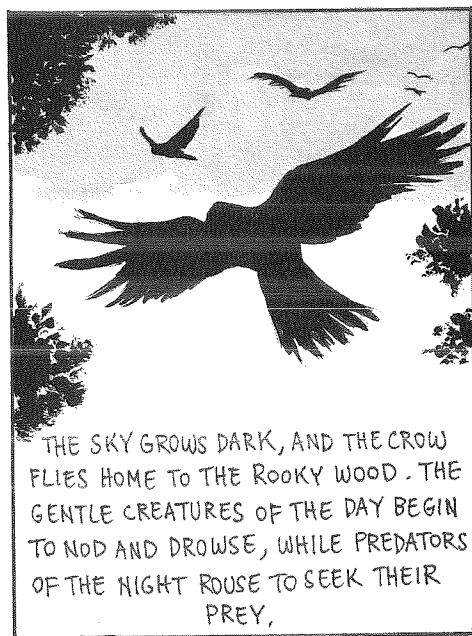


WHAT DEED IS THIS?

BETTER THAT YOU
ARE INNOCENT, DEAR
HEART, UNTIL THE
DEED IS DONE AND
YOU CAN APPLAUD
IT.



COME, NIGHT, AND BLINDFOLD
THE TENDERHEARTED DAY! WITH
YOUR BLOODY AND INVISIBLE
HAND, TEAR UP THE CONTRACT
OF BANQUO'S LIFE, WHICH
KEEPS ME IN FEAR!



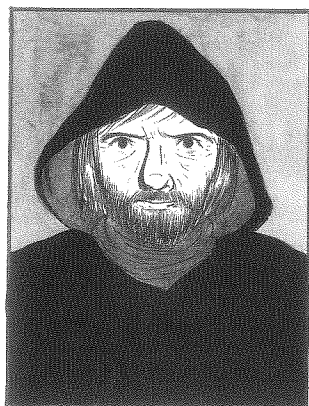
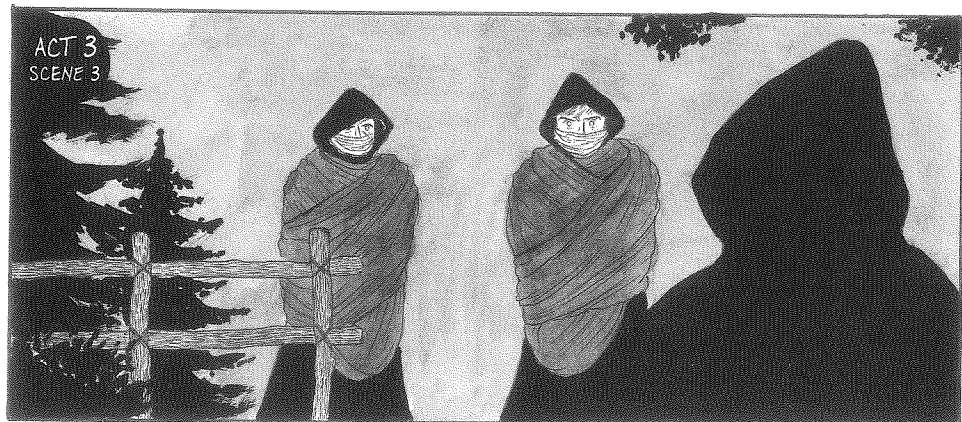
THE SKY GROWS DARK, AND THE CROW
FLIES HOME TO THE ROOKY WOOD. THE
GENTLE CREATURES OF THE DAY BEGIN
TO NOD AND DROWSE, WHILE PREDATORS
OF THE NIGHT ROUSE TO SEEK THEIR
PREY,

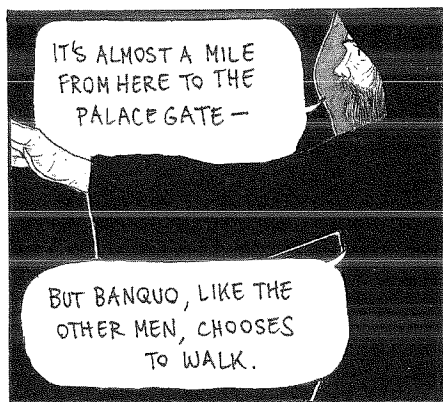
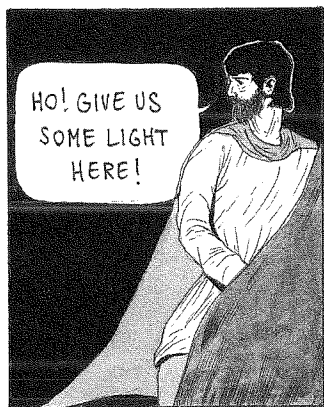
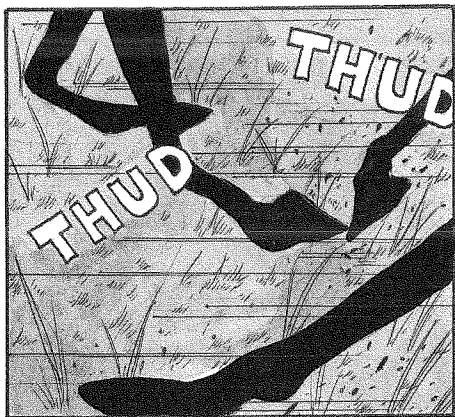


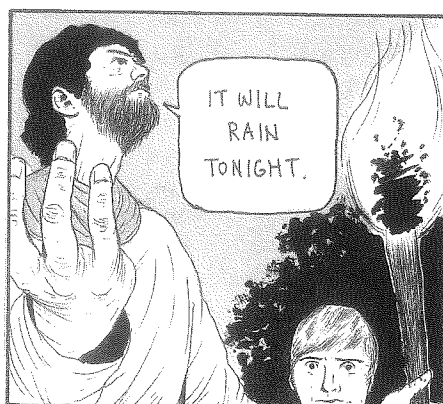
YOU LOOK SURPRISED AT MY WORDS,
BUT DO NOT QUESTION ME YET. BAD
DEEDS STRENGTHEN THEMSELVES
WITH FURTHER EVIL.

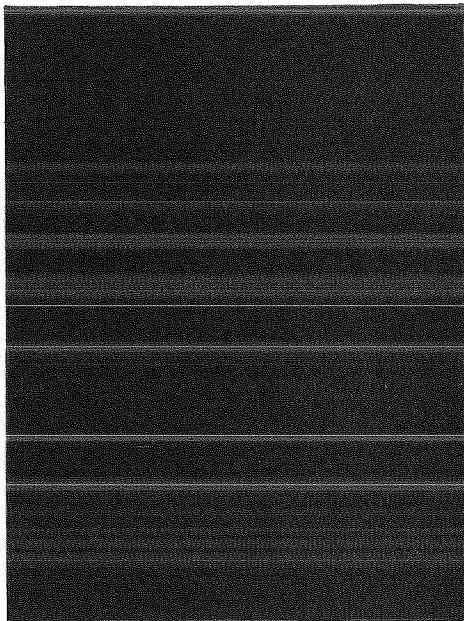
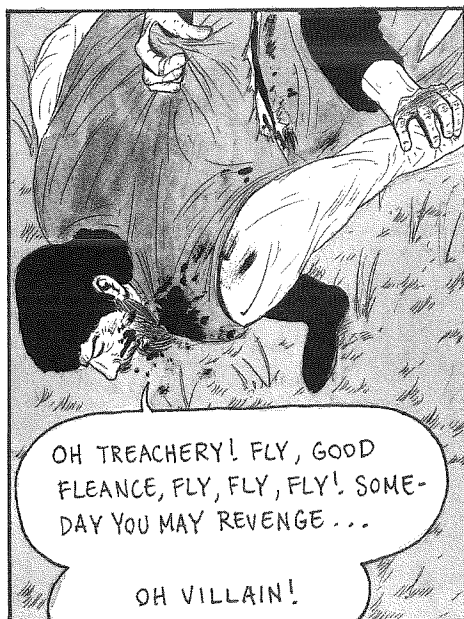
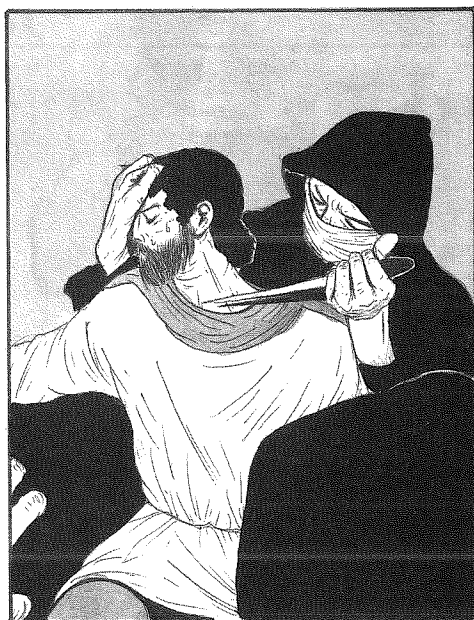
SO, I PRAY, GO
WITH ME.

ACT 3
SCENE 3









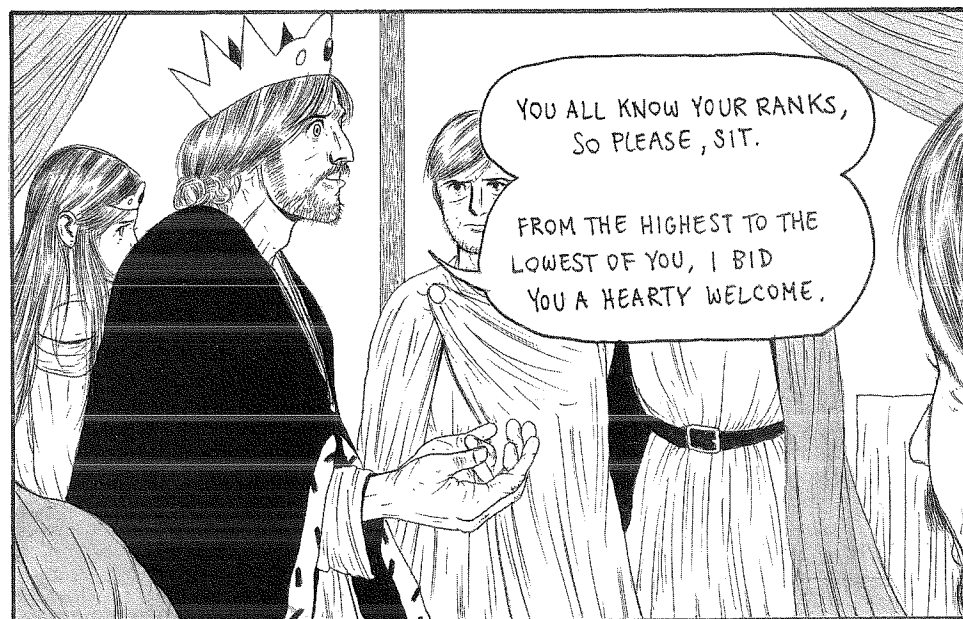
WHO STRUCK OUT THE LIGHT?

WASN'T THAT THE PLAN?

THERE'S ONLY ONE BODY
HERE. THE SON HAS FLED.

WE HAVE FAILED IN HALF
OUR MISSION.

WELL, LET'S BE GONE, TO TELL MACBETH
WHAT WE DID ACCOMPLISH.



THANKS TO YOUR MAJESTY.



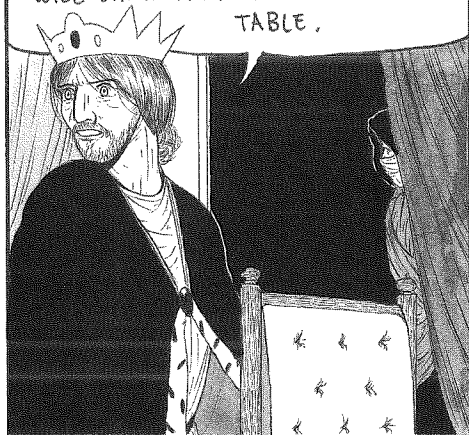
AS FOR OUR ROYAL SELF, WE
WILL MINGLE AMONG YOU
AND PLAY THE HUMBLE
HOST. OUR QUEEN KEEPS TO
HER CHAIR OF STATE, BUT
SOON WE WILL BID HER RISE
TO WELCOME YOU ALL.



SAY WELCOME TO OUR FRIENDS
FOR ME, FOR IN MY HEART
THEY ARE ALL WELCOME.

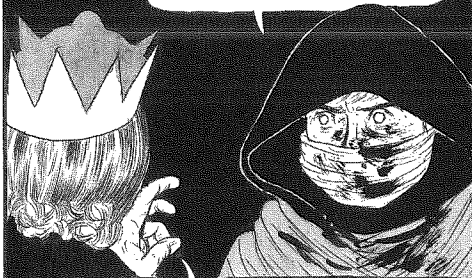


AND THEIR HEARTS RESPOND TO YOU WITH THANKS. THE TABLE IS FULL ON BOTH SIDES, SO I'LL SIT HERE, IN THE MIDDLE. BE FREE AND MERRY! SOON WE WILL DRINK A ROUND AROUND THE TABLE.



THERE'S BLOOD UPON YOUR FACE.

IT IS BANQUO'S, THEN.



BETTER SPLATTERED ON YOUR FACE THAN FLOWING THROUGH HIS VEINS. IS HE FINISHED?

MY LORD, HIS THROAT IS CUT. THAT I DID FOR HIM.

YOU ARE THE BEST OF THE CUTTHROATS! WHOEVER DID THE SAME TO FLEANCE IS ALSO WORTHY — AND IF YOU KILLED BOTH, THEN YOU ARE THE CHAMPION.

MOST ROYAL SIR, FLEANCE HAS ESCAPED.



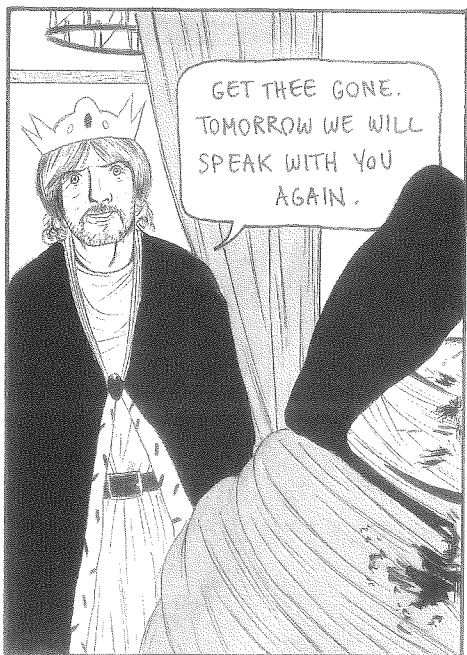
NOW THE FEVER OF FEAR
COMES AGAIN... OTHERWISE
I WOULD HAVE BEEN PER-
FECT! SOLID AS MARBLE,
FIRM AS ROCK, FREE
AS THE AIR ITSELF. BUT
NOW I AM CRAMPED,
ENCLOSED, CONFINED
BY MY DOUBTS AND
FEARS...

BUT BANQUO
IS SECURED?

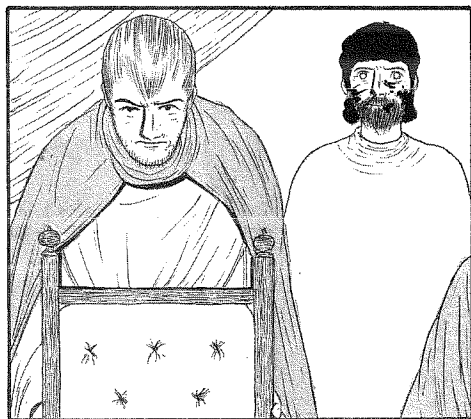
YES, MY GOOD LORD. SECURED IN A
DITCH, WITH TWENTY DEEP GASHES
IN HIS HEAD, EACH ONE A CERTAIN
DEATH.



THANKS FOR THAT. THE GROWN
SERPENT LIES THERE DEAD—BUT
THE YOUNG WORM THAT ESCAPED
WILL BREED HIS VENOM, GIVEN
TIME. BUT FOR NOW HE HAS NO
FANGS.

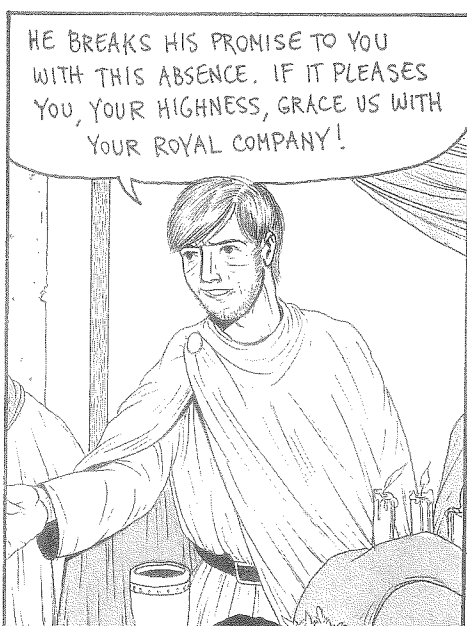


GET THEE GONE.
TOMORROW WE WILL
SPEAK WITH YOU
AGAIN.





IF BANQUO WERE HERE, THEN ALL THE NOBILITY OF SCOTLAND WOULD BE GATHERED UNDER OUR ROOF. I HOPE THAT HE IS LATE OUT OF SIMPLE RUDENESS AND NOT BECAUSE OF SOME MISFORTUNE.



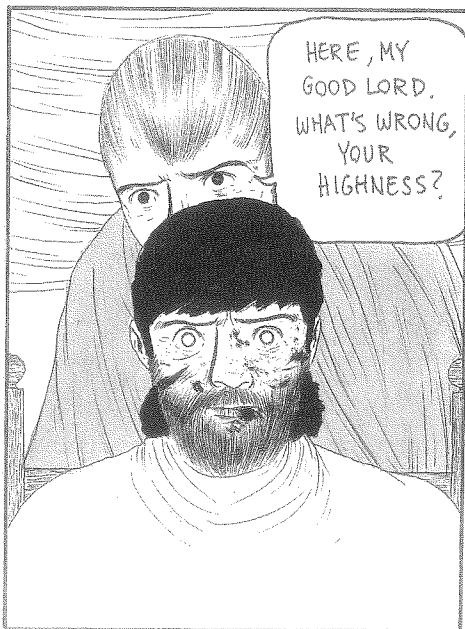
HE BREAKS HIS PROMISE TO YOU WITH THIS ABSENCE. IF IT PLEASES YOU, YOUR HIGHNESS, GRACE US WITH YOUR ROYAL COMPANY!



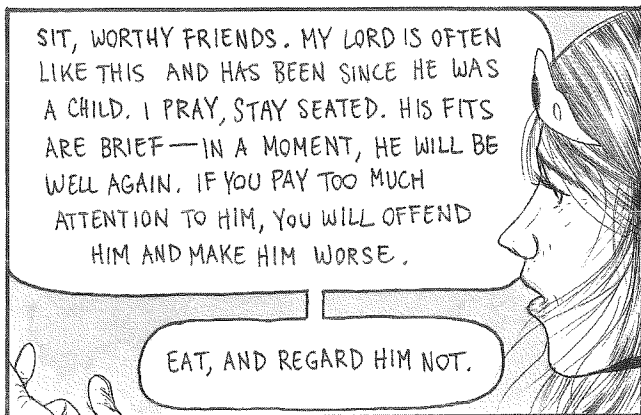
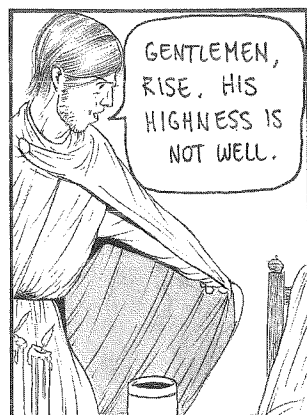
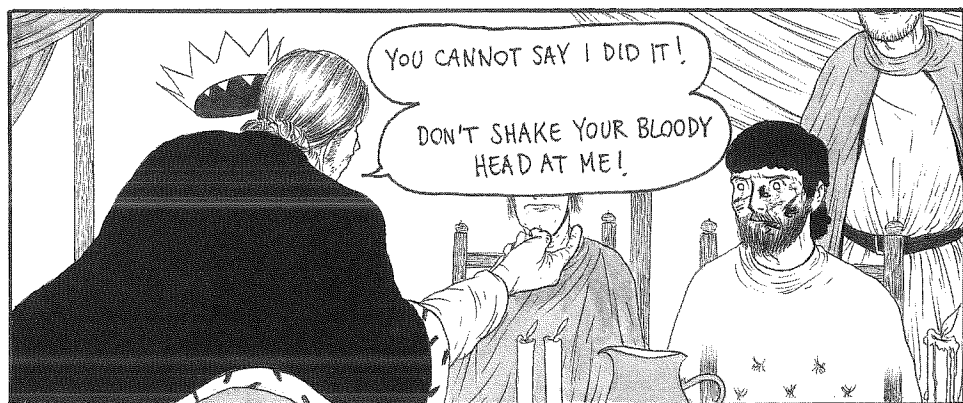
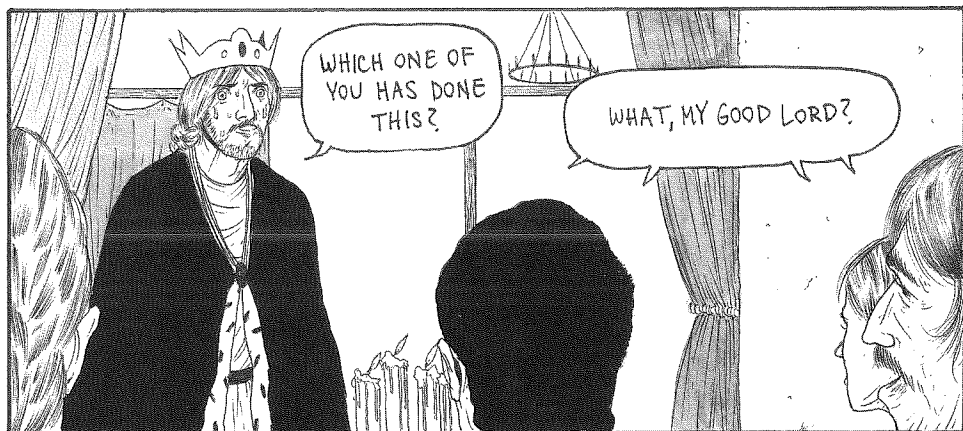
THE TABLE'S FULL.

HERE'S AN EMPTY SEAT, SIR.

WHERE?



HERE, MY GOOD LORD. WHAT'S WRONG, YOUR HIGHNESS?



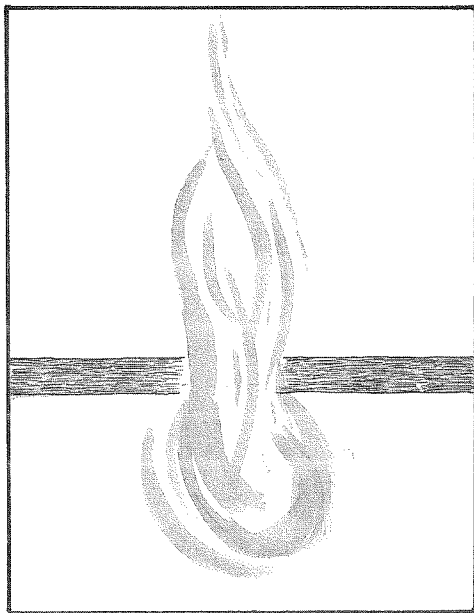
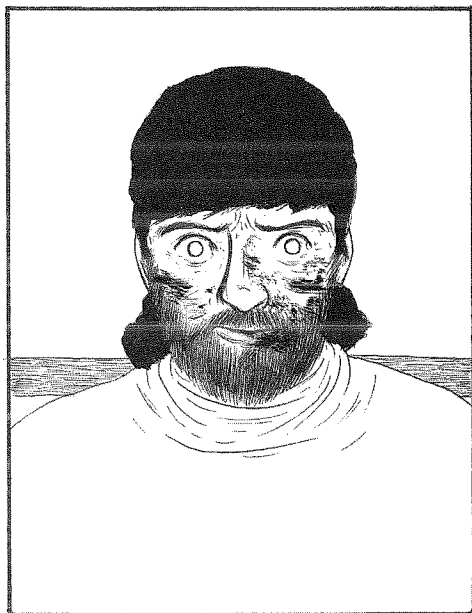
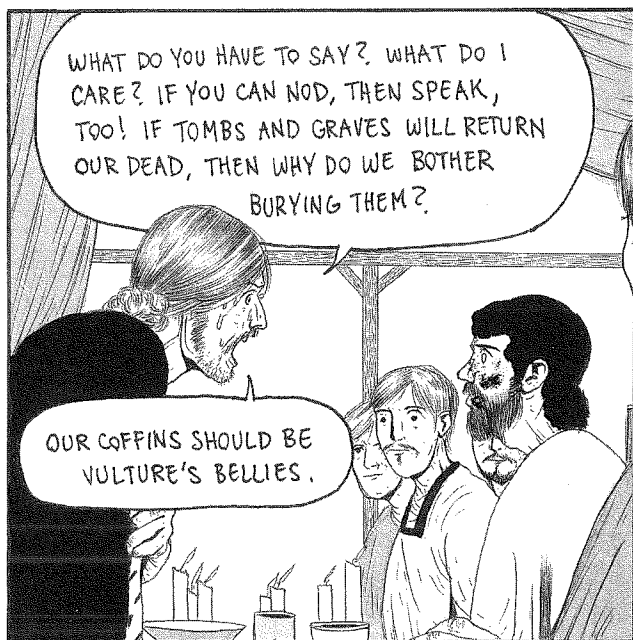
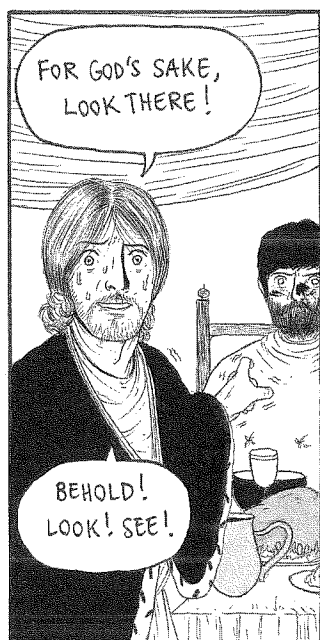


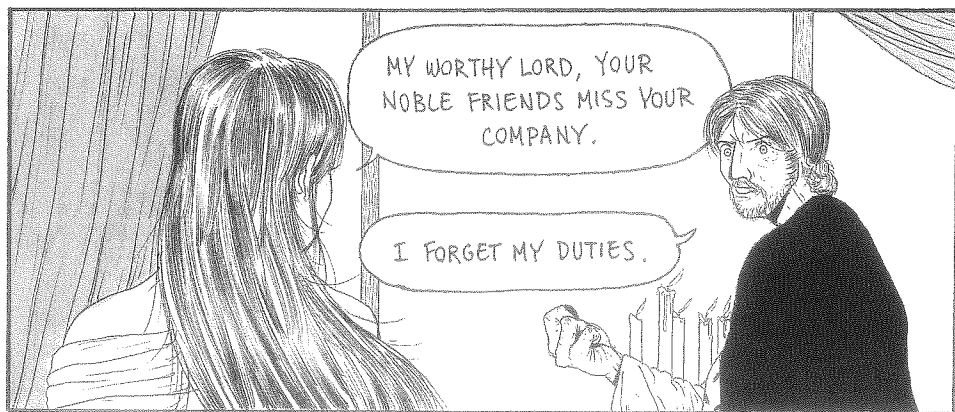
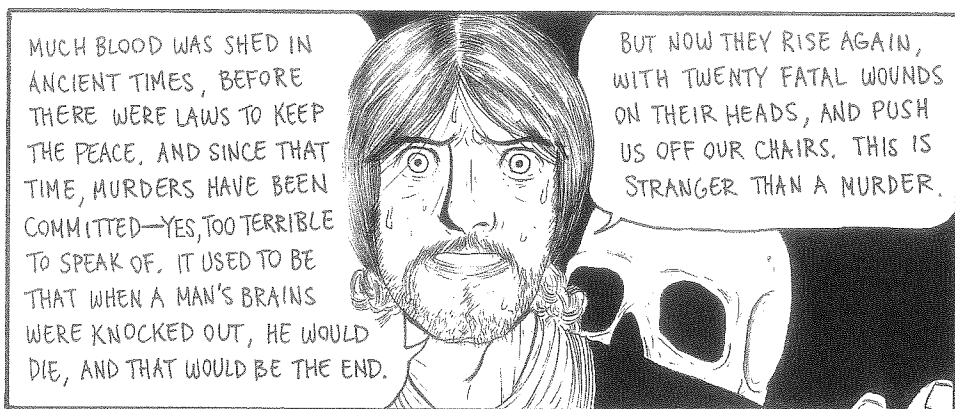
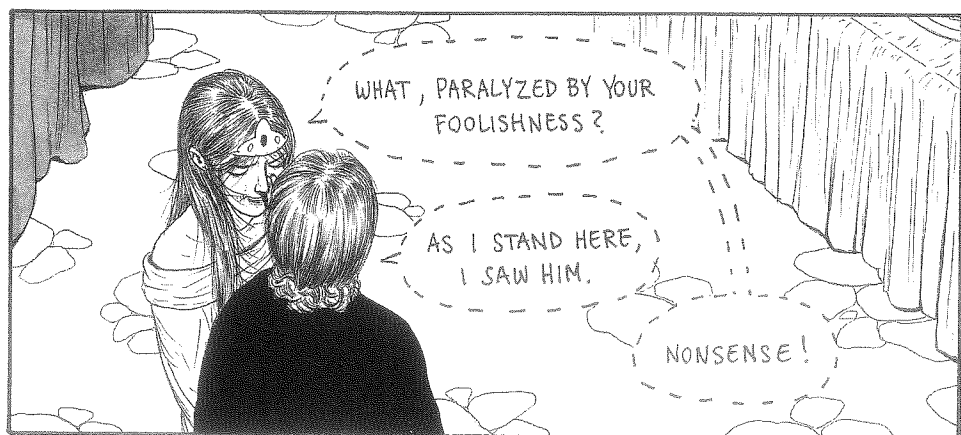
ARE YOU A MAN?

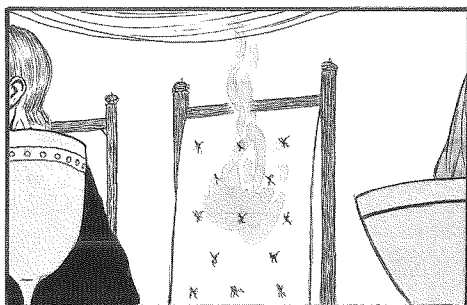
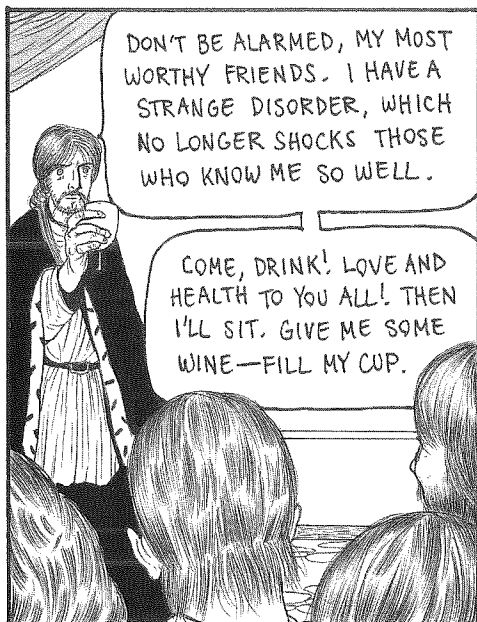
YES, AND A BOLD ONE—ONE
WHO DARES LOOK UPON THAT
WHICH WOULD FRIGHTEN THE
DEVIL!

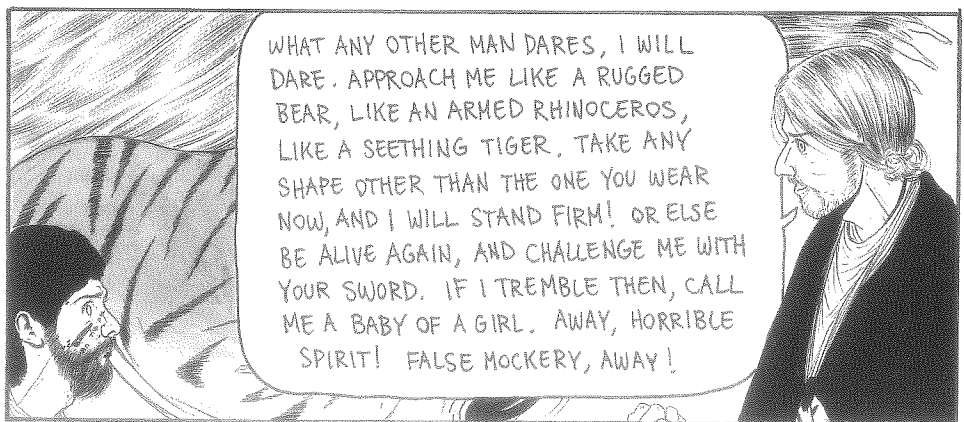
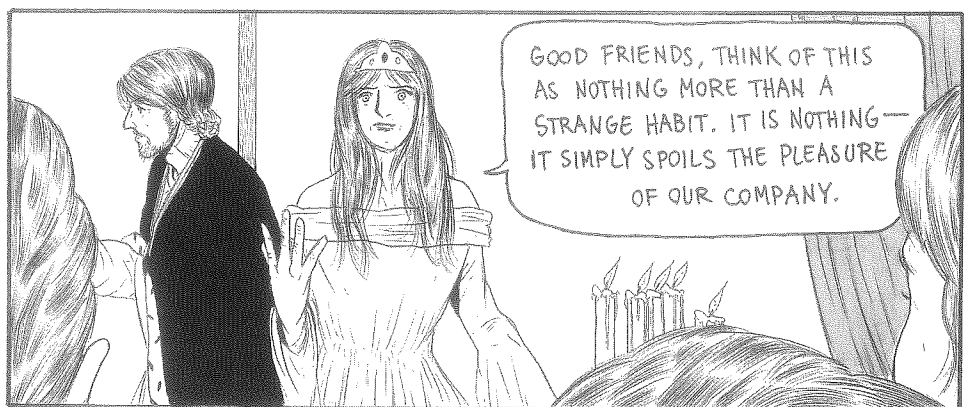
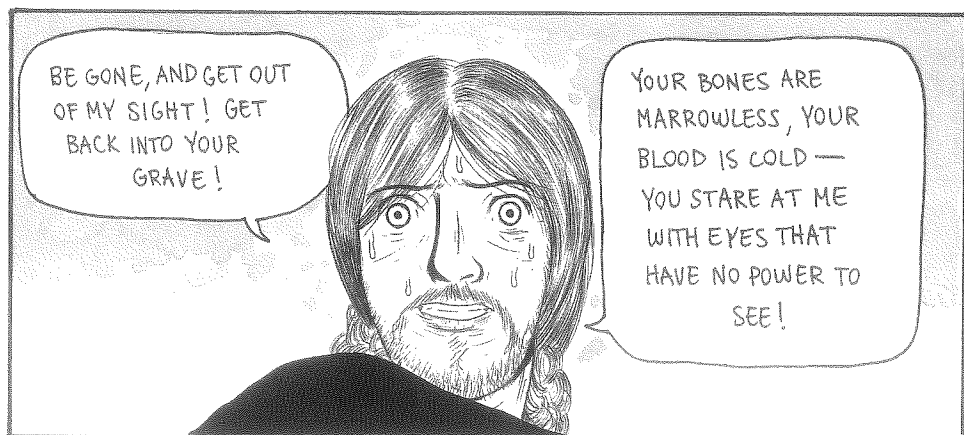
OH, WHAT NONSENSE! THIS IS JUST ANOTHER HALLUCINATION
BORN OF YOUR FEAR, LIKE THE FLOATING DAGGER THAT
YOU SAID LED YOU TO DUNCAN. THESE OUTBURSTS OF YOURS
DON'T EVEN RESEMBLE TRUE FEAR! YOU ACT AS IF YOU
WERE LISTENING TO A WOMAN'S STORY AT A WINTER
FIRE—SITTING NEXT TO HER GRANDMOTHER!

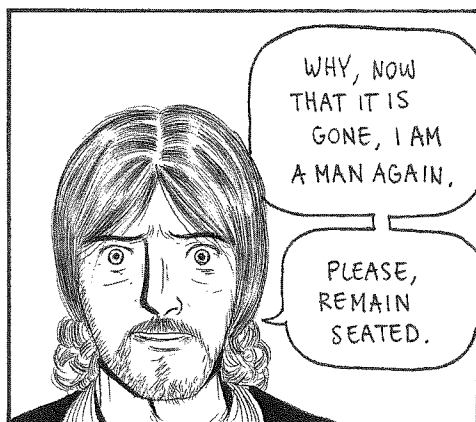
SHAME ON YOU! WHY DO YOU MAKE THESE
FACES? WHEN THE VISION PASSES, YOU WILL SEE
THAT IT'S JUST AN EMPTY CHAIR.

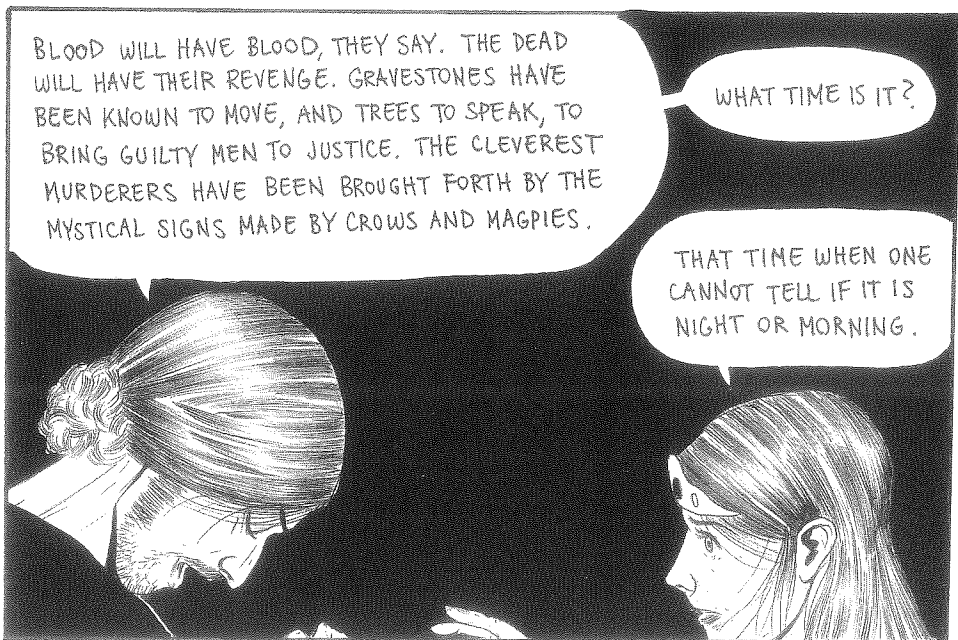


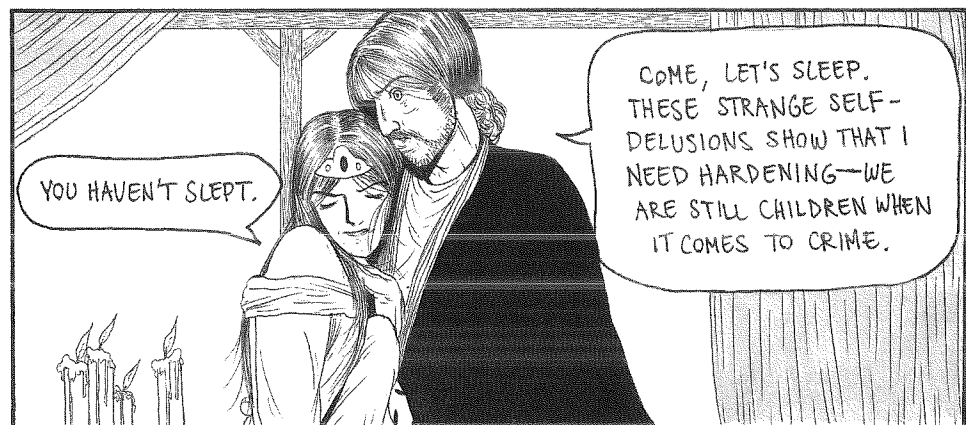
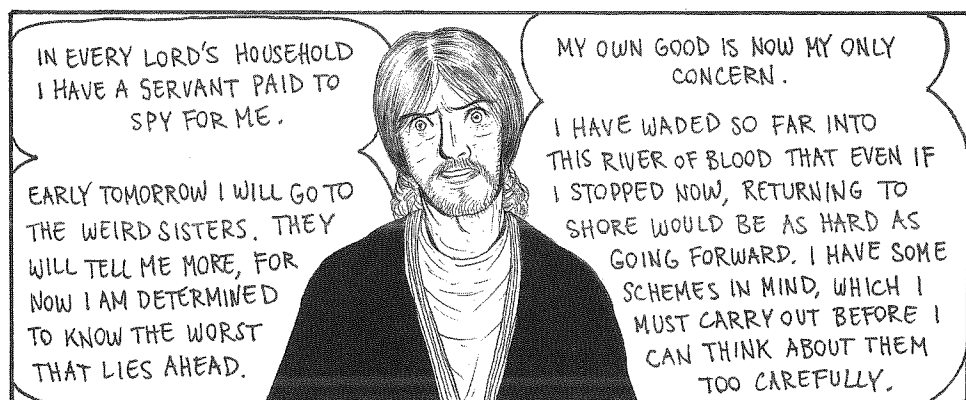
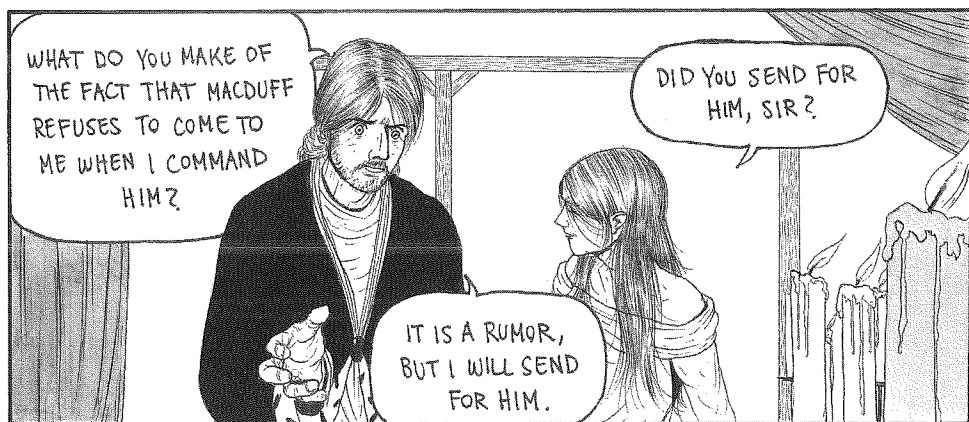


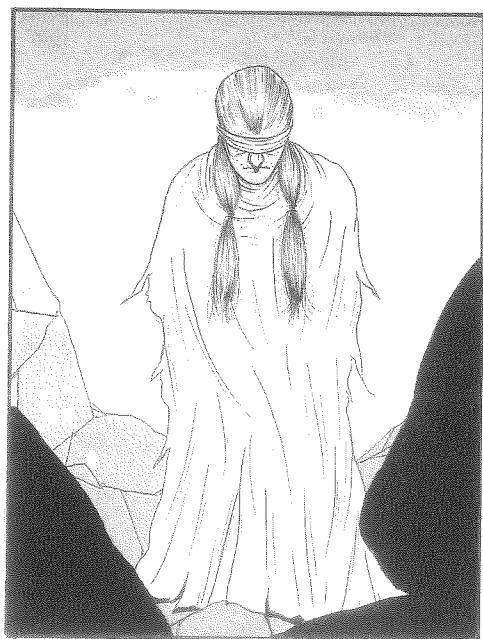
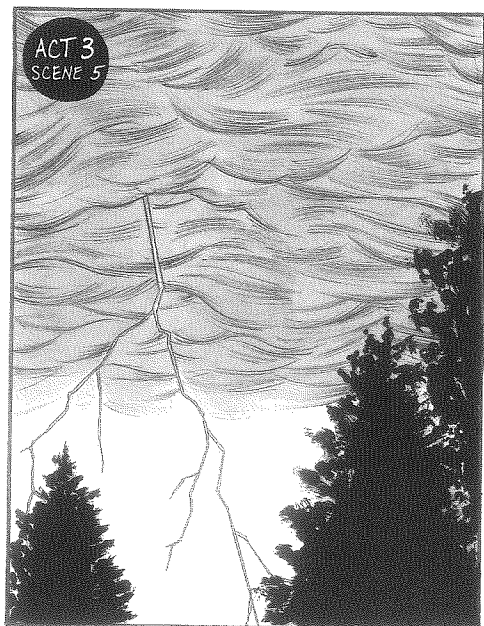










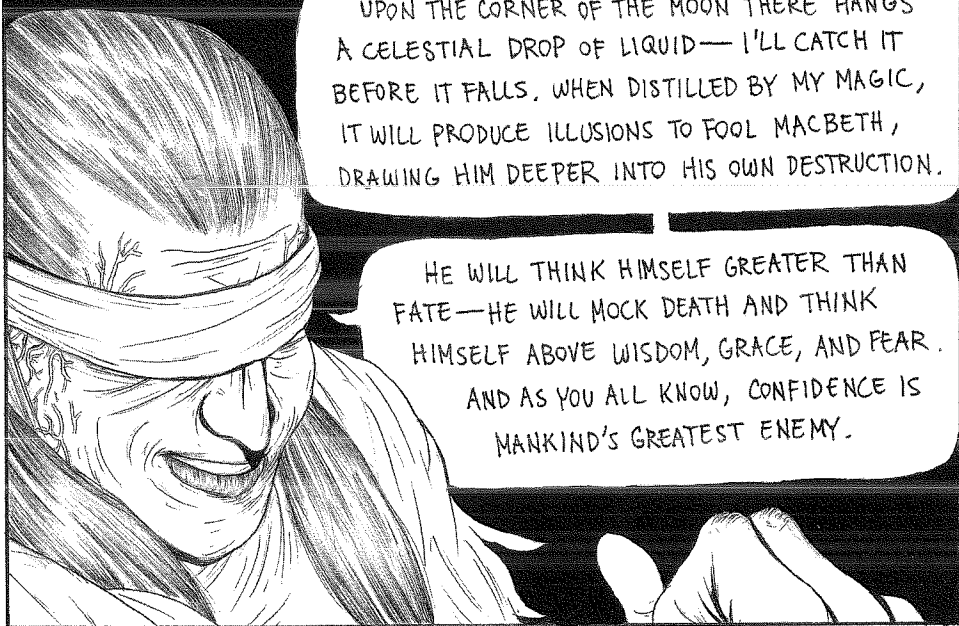


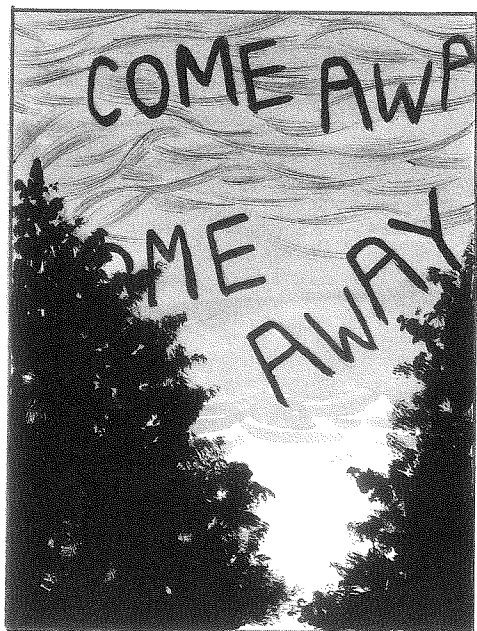
I AM YOUR MISTRESS—THE SOURCE OF YOUR POWERS, THE SECRET ENGINEER OF ALL EVILS! WHY WAS I NEVER CALLED UPON TO PLAY MY PART OR DEMONSTRATE THE GLORY OF MY POWERS? AND WHAT'S WORSE, YOU'VE DONE ALL THIS FOR A SPOILED CHILD FULL OF WRATH AND SPITE, WHO—LIKE ALL MEN—ACTS ONLY FOR HIMSELF AND NOT FOR YOU . . . AND YET, YOU MAY MAKE AMENDS TO ME.

BE GONE NOW, AND TOMORROW MORNING MEET ME AT THE HELL-RIVER ACHERON. MACBETH WILL COME THERE TO LEARN HIS DESTINY. BRING YOUR CAULDRONS AND YOUR SPELLS, YOUR CHARMS AND EVERYTHING ELSE. I WILL NOW TAKE TO THE AIR, TO SPEND THIS NIGHT CRAFTING DISASTER AND DOOM. GREAT EVENTS WILL STRIKE BEFORE NOON.

UPON THE CORNER OF THE MOON THERE HANGS A CELESTIAL DROP OF LIQUID—I'LL CATCH IT BEFORE IT FALLS. WHEN DISTILLED BY MY MAGIC, IT WILL PRODUCE ILLUSIONS TO FOOL MACBETH, DRAWING HIM DEEPER INTO HIS OWN DESTRUCTION.

HE WILL THINK HIMSELF GREATER THAN FATE—HE WILL MOCK DEATH AND THINK HIMSELF ABOVE WISDOM, GRACE, AND FEAR. AND AS YOU ALL KNOW, CONFIDENCE IS MANKIND'S GREATEST ENEMY.





ACT 3
SCENE 6

IT SEEMS WE ARE OF THE SAME MIND—THEREFORE,
YOU MAY DRAW YOUR OWN CONCLUSIONS. ALL I CAN SAY
IS THAT SOMETHING STRANGE IS HAPPENING.

MACBETH SHOWED GREAT CONCERN FOR DUNCAN —
AFTER HE WAS DEAD.

AND THE EVER-VALIANT BANQUO WENT WALKING TOO LATE AT
NIGHT; IF YOU LIKE, YOU MIGHT ASSUME THAT FLEANCE KILLED HIM,
SINCE HE HAS FLED THE SCENE OF THE CRIME. CLEARLY, MEN
SHOULD AVOID LEAVING THEIR HOUSES TOO LATE AT NIGHT.

AND WHO CAN HELP THINKING HOW MONSTROUS IT WAS FOR MALCOLM
AND DONALBAIN TO KILL THEIR GRACIOUS FATHER? A DAMNING CRIME!
HOW IT GRIEVED MACBETH... DIDN'T HE IMMEDIATELY KILL THOSE
TWO DELINQUENT GUARDS IN A PIOUS RAGE? WASN'T THAT NOBLE
OF HIM? YES, AND WISE, TOO, FOR WE ALL WOULD HAVE BEEN
OUTRAGED TO HEAR THOSE TWO DENY THEIR CRIME.



SO I SAY THAT MACBETH HAS
HANDLED THINGS WELL.



IF HE HAD DUNCAN'S SONS IN PRISON—WHICH I HOPE TO
GOD WON'T HAPPEN—THEY WOULD LEARN JUST HOW
HORRIBLE A PUNISHMENT IS RESERVED FOR THOSE WHO
KILL THEIR FATHERS—AS WOULD FLEANCE.

BUT ENOUGH OF THAT. I HEAR THAT MACDUFF IS OUT
OF THE TYRANT'S FAVOR, SINCE HE SPEAKS HIS
MIND TOO PLAINLY AND FAILED TO APPEAR AT THE
FEAST. SIR, DO YOU KNOW WHERE HE HIDES HIMSELF?

DUNCAN'S SON MALCOLM—WHOSE BIRTHRIGHT WAS STOLEN BY THE TYRANT
BETH—LIVES NOW AT THE ENGLISH COURT. THERE, THE SAINTLY KING
ARD TREATS HIM SO GRACIOUSLY THAT, DESPITE HIS EXILE, MALCOLM
LOSES NONE OF HIS DIGNITY.

FF HAS GONE TO ENGLAND TO ASK HOLY KING
D FOR AID. HE WISHES TO FORM AN ALLIANCE WITH
PLE OF NORTH UMBERLAND AND THEIR WAR-
RD, SIWARD. MACDUFF HOPES THAT WITH
ELP—AND THE HELP OF GOD ABOVE—WE
E AGAIN PUT FOOD ON OUR TABLES, BRING
OUR NIGHTS, DRIVE BLOODY KNIVES FROM
S AND BANGUETS, PAY HOMAGE TO A
G, AND ENJOY OUR HONORS
IN FREEDOM.

OUR PEOPLE YEARN FOR ALL OF THIS. MACBETH HEARS THIS NEWS, AND IT HAS ANGERED HIM TO THE POINT OF WAR.

HAS HE SENT FOR MACDUFF AND COMMANDED HIM TO RETURN TO SCOTLAND?

HE HAS, AND MACDUFF GAVE THE ENVOY A DEFIANT "SIR, NOT I." THEN THE SCOWLING MESSENGER RUDELY TURNED HIS BACK ON MACDUFF, AS IF TO SAY, "YOU'LL REGRET THE DAY YOU GAVE ME THIS ANSWER."

ALAS, THAT MAY WELL URGE MACDUFF TO EXERCISE CAUTION AND KEEP AWAY FROM HERE. OH, I WISH SOME HOLY ANGEL WOULD FLY TO THE COURT OF ENGLAND AND TELL MACDUFF THAT HE MUST RETURN QUICKLY, FOR HIS COUNTRY SUFFERS UNDER THE CURSED HAND OF A TYRANT!

I'LL SEND MY PRAYERS WITH H